

Germany 1925–1955: The People and the State (J410/02)

This depth study focuses on the relationship between the German people and the Nazi regime that ruled Germany from 1933–1945. The depth study ranges from 1925–1955 in order to provide the context for the Nazi period in Germany.

Learners will need to be familiar with the key issues specified in the introduction to the non-British depth studies on page 12 of the specification. These issues will be assessed.

Key Topics	Content Learners should have studied the following:
The rise and consolidation of the Nazi regime 1925–1934	Strengths and weaknesses of the Weimar Republic 1925–1928, including Nazi policies in the 1920s and the position of the party in 1928; the impact of the Depression on different groups in Germany; the political, social and economic crisis of 1929–1933; rising support for Nazis 1929–1933; the Nazi consolidation of power 1933–1934, including the Reichstag Fire, the suspension of the Weimar constitution and the Enabling Act, the elections of March 1933, the takeover of/ or collaboration with key institutions (particularly the army), and the elimination of opposition (including trade unions, opposition parties and the SA).
Nazi Germany and its people 1933–1939	Elements of the Nazi terror state, including the SA, SS, Gestapo, SD, courts and police; Nazi use of culture and propaganda; personal popularity of Hitler; attempts to create a National Community; economic policies of Nazi regime and their effects on sections of German society (winners and losers); Nazi social policies, including policies on women and youth; the lack of effective opposition to the regime; persecution of Jews and other groups, including Roma, Jehovah's Witnesses and homosexuals; eugenics policies.
War and its legacy 1939–1955	Initial reaction to outbreak of war; changing fortunes of Germany in the war (initial gains and colonisation in East); growing impact of war, including bombing; extent of support for war effort; opposition during war; escalation of racial persecution leading to the Holocaust; defeat and occupation; Allied policy of de-Nazification (methods and impact); the differing experiences of people in East and West Germany 1945–1955.